

MERIDIAN & ASSOCIATES LLP

Bid & Pursuit Performance Summary

Fiscal Years 2022 - 2025 | Year-to-Date FY2026

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CLASSIFICATION: CONFIDENTIAL

1. Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive analysis of Meridian & Associates LLP's bid and pursuit activity spanning fiscal years 2022 through 2025, with year-to-date figures for FY2026. Over this period, the firm evaluated 347 bid opportunities, pursued 278 (80%), and achieved a 60% win rate on pursued engagements. The data reflects a consistent upward trajectory in win rates, deal size, and pursuit efficiency, while highlighting areas requiring strategic investment.

347 Total Bids Evaluated	278 Pursued (Go Decisions)	167 Won	60% Overall Win Rate
69 (20%) No-Bid Decisions	98 (35%) Losses	13 (5%) Withdrawn	\$2.4M Avg Deal Size (FY25)

Year-Over-Year Bid Volume

Fiscal Year	Evaluated	Pursued	Won	Lost	Withdrawn	No-Bid	Win Rate
FY2022	72	58	32	22	4	14	56%
FY2023	81	65	39	22	4	16	60%
FY2024	89	72	46	24	2	17	64%
FY2025	92	73	46	25	2	19	63%
FY2026 YTD	13	10	4	5	1	3	40%*

* FY2026 YTD reflects Q1 only; win rate expected to normalize as pipeline matures.

KEY INSIGHT

Win rate has improved from 56% in FY2022 to 63% in FY2025, driven by stronger bid/no-bid discipline, industry specialization investments, and the multi-service bundling strategy.

2. Win Rate Analysis

2.1 Win Rate by Industry Vertical

Industry-specific win rates reveal the firm's competitive strengths and gaps. Financial Services and Energy lead at 66%, while Public Sector trails at 52%, reflecting a need for investment in cleared personnel and government-specific compliance frameworks.

Industry Win Rates

Financial Services		82 bids 54 won 66%
Energy		38 bids 25 won 66%
Manufacturing		48 bids 31 won 65%
Healthcare		61 bids 39 won 64%
Technology		45 bids 26 won 58%
Retail		31 bids 17 won 55%
Public Sector		42 bids 22 won 52%

2.2 Win Rate by Service Line

Service Line	Bids	Won	Win Rate	Avg Deal Value
Multi-Service	23	18	78%	\$4.1M
Audit & Assurance	98	65	66%	\$2.8M
Tax Services	72	47	65%	\$1.6M
Advisory & Consulting	85	48	56%	\$2.9M

MULTI-SERVICE ADVANTAGE

Multi-service (bundled) engagements achieve a 78% win rate -- the highest across all service lines -- and are growing 22% year-over-year. The firm should continue expanding cross-service pursuit teams.

3. Loss Reason Analysis

Of the 98 competitive losses recorded from FY2022 to FY2025, a structured loss debrief was conducted for 91 (93%). The following analysis categorizes root causes and identifies actionable improvement areas.

Primary Loss Reasons (n = 98)

Price Competitiveness		42% (41 losses) Avg gap: 18% above winner
Incumbent Advantage		23% (23 losses) Mostly audit rotation retained
Capability Gap		15% (15 losses) Niche ERP, cleared personnel
Relationship / Politics		12% (12 losses) Pre-wired RFPs, board ties
Compliance / Geographic		8% (7 losses) Local presence, certifications

3.1 Price Competitiveness Detail

Price was cited as the primary loss reason in 42% of defeats. Detailed analysis shows the average pricing gap was 18% above the winning bidder. However, 60% of price-driven losses occurred in Advisory & Consulting, where blended rates are under the most competitive pressure. The GDC cost model has partially addressed this -- pursuit teams that leveraged the Global Delivery Center achieved a 69% win rate versus 52% without.

3.2 Strategic Recommendations from Loss Analysis

1. Expand GDC utilization in Advisory proposals to improve rate competitiveness
2. Invest in FedRAMP / cleared personnel pipeline to address public sector capability gaps
3. Develop formal incumbent displacement playbook with 18-month relationship-building lead time
4. Implement competitive intelligence process to identify pre-wired RFPs earlier in the cycle
5. Establish regional alliance partnerships to address geographic coverage gaps

4. Pursuit Cost & Economics

The firm invests approximately \$10.6 million annually in pursuit activities. Effective bid/no-bid discipline and rising win rates have improved pursuit ROI significantly over the reporting period.

\$38K Avg Pursuit Cost	1.4% Cost as % of Deal	\$10.6M Annual Investment	14.2x Pursuit ROI
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4.1 Pursuit Cost by Engagement Size

Deal Size Tier	Avg Pursuit Cost	Range	Win Rate	ROI
< \$500K	\$8K	\$3K - \$15K	68%	22.1x
\$500K - \$2M	\$28K	\$12K - \$55K	62%	16.8x
\$2M - \$5M	\$62K	\$30K - \$95K	58%	13.4x
\$5M - \$10M	\$95K	\$50K - \$140K	55%	11.2x
> \$10M	\$148K	\$80K - \$180K	51%	9.8x

4.2 Annual Pursuit Investment Trend

Fiscal Year	Total Investment	Bids Pursued	Cost/Bid	Won Revenue	ROI
FY2022	\$8.7M	58	\$150K	\$57.6M	6.6x
FY2023	\$9.8M	65	\$151K	\$101.4M	10.3x
FY2024	\$10.8M	72	\$150K	\$147.2M	13.6x
FY2025	\$11.0M	73	\$151K	\$156.4M	14.2x

EFFICIENCY GAINS

Pursuit ROI has more than doubled from 6.6x in FY2022 to 14.2x in FY2025, driven by stronger bid/no-bid discipline (20% no-bid rate) and larger average deal sizes.

5. Win Theme Effectiveness

Analysis of winning proposals identifies five recurring themes most strongly correlated with positive outcomes. Proposals incorporating three or more of these themes achieved a combined 76% win rate.

Win Rate When Theme Is Present in Proposal

Multi-service integration		78% Used in 23 bids
Industry specialization / named SMEs		73% Used in 142 bids
Past performance / case studies		71% Used in 189 bids
GDC cost model / blended rates		69% Used in 96 bids
Proprietary technology (MeridianAI)		67% Used in 78 bids

5.1 Theme Combination Analysis

Themes in Proposal	Bids	Won	Win Rate
0-1 themes	52	24	46%
2 themes	89	51	57%
3 themes	78	53	68%
4+ themes	59	45	76%

RECOMMENDATION

All pursuit teams should target inclusion of at least three win themes per proposal. BD leadership should gate proposal submissions on theme checklist completion.

6. Competitive Win/Loss Analysis

Head-to-head competitive data is tracked for five primary competitors. The firm performs strongest against RSK International (68% win rate) and weakest against Whitfield & Crane (40%), the latter being the firm's most frequent competitor.

Competitor	Head-to-Head	We Won	We Lost	Win Rate	Primary Threat
RSK International	22	15	7	68%	Global reach
Hensley Pratt	31	19	12	61%	Tax specialization
Calloway Donovan	38	22	16	58%	Technology practice
Novak Bishop Group	28	16	12	57%	Regional depth
Whitfield & Crane	45	18	27	40%	Price, incumbency

6.1 Whitfield & Crane Deep-Dive

As the firm's most formidable competitor (45 head-to-head encounters, 40% win rate), Whitfield & Crane warrants dedicated counter-strategy. Key competitive disadvantages observed include:

- Consistently 10-15% lower fee structure due to larger offshore delivery capacity
- Stronger incumbent retention in audit rotations (they retain 72% of defenses vs. our 58%)
- Deeper bench in financial services regulatory advisory
- More aggressive pursuit investment (estimated 2.1% of deal value vs. our 1.4%)

6.2 Recommended Counter-Strategies

1. Develop W&C-specific competitive battle cards with differentiated messaging
2. Pre-position relationships 18+ months ahead of known rotation cycles
3. Lead with MeridianAI differentiation where W&C relies on manual processes
4. Pursue joint-bid opportunities in sectors where we are complementary

7. Trends & Strategic Outlook

7.1 Key Performance Trends (FY2022 to FY2025)

Metric	FY2022	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	Trend
Win rate (pursued)	56%	60%	64%	63%	Improving
Average deal size	\$1.8M	\$2.0M	\$2.2M	\$2.4M	Growing
Multi-svc % of bids	5%	7%	9%	12%	Growing 22% YoY
Public sector win rate	58%	55%	52%	48%	Declining
No-bid rate	19%	20%	19%	21%	Stable
Pursuit ROI	6.6x	10.3x	13.6x	14.2x	Strong growth

7.2 FY2026 Strategic Priorities

- Achieve 65% overall win rate by expanding theme-based proposal methodology
- Grow multi-service pursuits to 15% of total bids (from 12%)
- Reverse public sector win rate decline through cleared personnel hiring initiative
- Reduce price-driven losses by 20% through expanded GDC utilization in Advisory
- Launch competitive intelligence program targeting Whitfield & Crane displacement
- Implement formal pursuit cost tracking at engagement level for ROI optimization

7.3 Pipeline Outlook (FY2026)

The current qualified pipeline contains 42 active opportunities with an estimated total contract value of \$138M. Based on current win rates and pipeline stage weighting, the firm projects \$78M-\$92M in new wins for FY2026, representing 12-18% growth over FY2025.

OUTLOOK

The firm is well-positioned for continued growth, with improving win rates, larger deal sizes, and a robust pipeline. Key risks include public sector capability gaps and pricing pressure from Whitfield & Crane in the financial services vertical.